

Assignment 1: Startup Showcase Work Plan

You are tasked with managing a Startup Showcase where selected startups will pitch their solutions to industry stakeholders focused on industry decarbonisation.

Prepare a concise **work plan** (maximum 1 page) outlining your approach to executing the event. Your plan may include:

- Key milestones and activities
- Roles and responsibilities
- Any considerations or assumptions you make

You may choose to submit this in **Excel or Word format**, using a structure that best reflects your planning style (e.g., timeline view, task breakdown, Gantt-style table, etc.).

Startup Showcase Work Plan

Industrial decarbonisation Startup Showcase

Objective: Facilitate high-quality startup–industry engagement to accelerate industrial decarbonisation partnerships, pilot opportunities, procurement discussions, and strategic collaborations.

Execution Approach:

Approach	Scope
Assumption1	Showcase execution for already shortlisted startups
Assumption2	End-end program management (including outreach and screening)

Assumptions 1: The startup sourcing, application process, and initial screening/vetting have already been completed. The scope of this work plan focuses on preparing and executing the showcase event for shortlisted startups and industry stakeholders.

The showcase is assumed to feature ~30 startups pitching industrial decarbonisation solutions to 5 industry stakeholders across sectors such as steel, cement, fertilisers, pharmaceuticals, and climate-focused investors

Showcase Design Logic:

A fully open networking structure would create:

- 30 startups × 5 stakeholders = 150 meetings
- At 20 minutes per meeting = ~3000 minutes

This would reduce meeting quality and create stakeholder fatigue.

Instead, the showcase follows a relevance-based matchmaking approach.

Startup Cohort Design

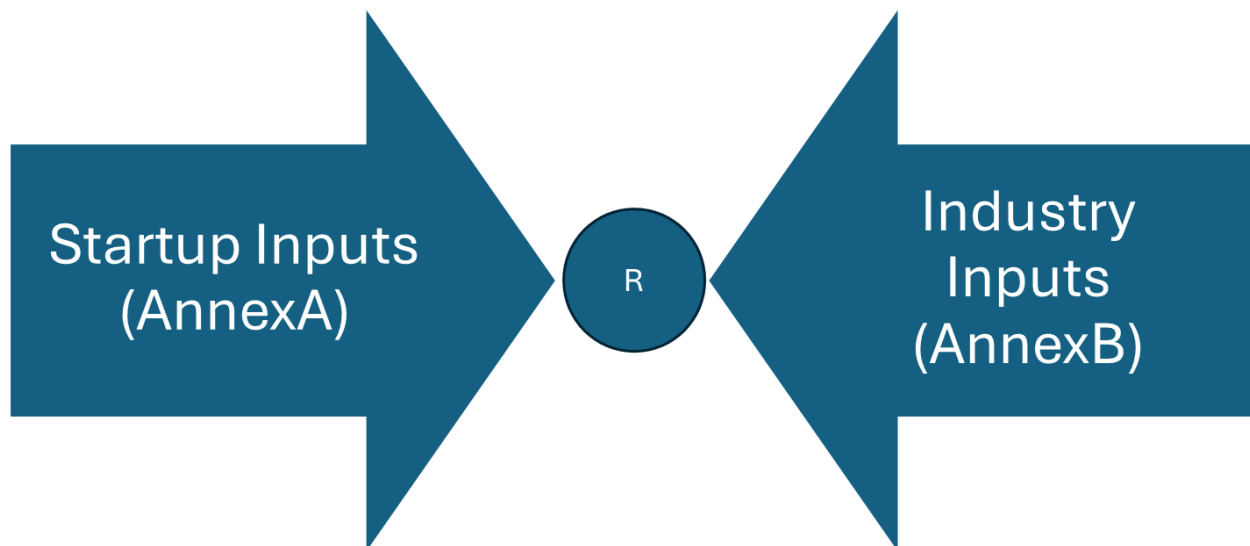
Stage	Approx. Count	Expected Outcome
Early Stage	~10	Visibility, pilot discussions

Growth Stage	~12	LOIs, work orders
Mature Stage	~8	Strategic partnerships, investments, supply-chain integration

The structure recognises that different startup maturity levels require different stakeholder interactions and commercial outcomes.

Matchmaking Framework

Before the showcase, both startups and industry stakeholders complete intake forms capturing sector relevance, value-chain focus, TRL, procurement readiness, and desired outcomes from both Startups and industry folk to find a relevance **R** or fitment.



Using the above, bilateral meetings are prioritized through a relevance-scoring framework:

Relevance Score = Sector Alignment x Industry Urgency (+Value chain Alignment Bonus, +Stage Compatibility Bonus)

High-scoring startup–industry matches are prioritised for structured meetings. This reduces low-value interactions while improving the probability of pilots, procurement conversations, partnerships, and investments.

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Startup and Industry Stakeholder Matchmaker

Rank bilateral matches and turn the strongest pairs into a meeting schedule.

[CSV column guide](#)

Startups CSV

200MB per file • CSV

Industry stakeholders CSV

200MB per file • CSV

Upload both CSV files to calculate relevance-ranked matches.

Operational Framework

Before week 1:
Project Charter

Element	Content
Project Name	Industrial Decarbonisation Startup Showcase
Project Sponsor	[Organisation]
Project Manager	Event Lead
Business Case	Industrial decarbonisation leaders lack structured access to vetted startup solutions. This event bridges that gap, accelerating procurement and partnership decisions.
Measurable Objectives	≥35% match conversation rate ≥5 LoI within 4 weeks Leader awareness score
Scope	30 startups x 5 leaders Single-day event 8-week delivery timeline
Out of Scope	Investor fundraising facilitation Media/PR Cohort Management
High-level budget	[Budget]
Key Stakeholders	5 industry leaders 30 startups

	Commissioning body Organiser team
Assumptions	Leaders confirmed before week 3, ≥80% intake form response rate Secure venue by week 4
Constraints	Fixed event dates 5 leaders only Single-day format
Risks	Leader cancellation Low intake response Stage bias in matching
Authorised by	Sponsor Signature

The accompanying Excel workbook titled - Decarbonisation Plan 1 contains:

1. Overview & assumptions
2. Work Plan
3. Roles & Responsibilities
4. Metrics & Risk
5. Event Day Schedule
6. RACI Matrix
7. Work Break Structure (WBS)
8. Stakeholder register

Assumptions2: The showcase team manages the end-to-end program lifecycle, including startup outreach, screening, cohort selection, stakeholder engagement, showcase execution, and post-event follow-up.

Program Structure:

1. Program Duration: 14 weeks
2. Phases: 5
3. Cohort Size: 8-12 startups
4. Audience: Stakeholders from the industry
5. Budget Owner: Program Director
6. Process: Initiation → Planning → Execution → Monitoring & Control → Closing
7. Assumptions for the project:
 - Budget approved before program launch (Week 1)
 - Program team of 4–5 FTEs available from Day 1
 - Startups are globally eligible; remote pitching permitted
 - At least one anchor stakeholder (corporate / DFI) confirmed by Week 6
 - Existing ecosystem relationships (UN, accelerators) leveraged for outreach
 - Event is hybrid-capable (in-person + virtual streaming)
8. Constraints for the project:
 - 14-week total timeline is fixed; no extension anticipated
 - Cohort capped at 12 startups due to event logistics
 - Budget subject to quarterly reforecast; change control required for >10% variance
 - Jury panel availability must be confirmed by Week 4
 - All external comms subject to organisational approval (3-day SLA)

Phase Overview:

#each phase has entry and exit criteria, owners, and measurable deliverables

Phase 1: Initiation & Scoping

Time: Week 1 and 2

SI no	Activity	Owner	Deliverables	Week	Notes
1	Develop program charter & ToR	Program Director	Program Charter Terms of reference	0	
2	Define success metrics & KPIs	PM + Director	KPI Framework (reach, quality, conversion)	0	
3	Identify & map stakeholders	PM + Communication lead	Stakeholder register & Engagement Plan	1	

4	Confirm Budget, tools & platforms	PM + Operations	Approved Budget Tracker Tech Stack Decision	1	
5	Stand up core team Assign roles	Program Director	RACI Matrix Kick-off completed	2	

Phase 2: Planning & Startup Outreach

Time: Week 2 to 5

SI no	Activity	Owner	Deliverables	Week	Notes
1	Develop startup outreach strategy	PM + Communication lead	Outreach plan	2	
2	Create application portal & criteria	PM + Tech lead	Live application form Scoring Rubric	2	
3	Launch outreach (ecosystems, different bodies)	Comms + PM	Outreach tracker (target: 80+ leads)	3	
4	Develop a stakeholder engagement plan	PM + Comms	Invitation list Briefing Pack	3	
5	Secure venue/ platform	Operation Lead	Venue Contract	4	
6	Draft run-of-show & agenda	PM	Master Event Agenda Speaker Grid	4 - 5	

Phase 3: Screening & Cohort Selection

Time: Week 5 to 8

SI no	Activity	Owner	Deliverables	Week	Notes
1	Application Screening	Coord. + PM	Screened	5	

	(Stage 1)		Shortlist (top30)		
2	Panel interviews/ pitch review (Stage2)	Jury Panel + PM	Interview scorecards	7	
3	Due Diligence on top candidates	PM + Subject Expert	DD report per startup	5 - 6	
4	Finalise the cohort of 8 to 12	Program Director	Official Selection List Offers Letters	7	
5	Onboard cohort	Program Coordinator	Onboarding pack Media releases	8	

Phase 4: Execution and Showcase day

Time: Week 9 to 12

SI no	Activity	Owner	Deliverables	Week	Notes
1	Stakeholder confirmation	Comms Lead	Comms Lead	8	
2	Pitch coaching (good turnout)	PM + Coach	PM + Coaching	9	
3	Finalise AV, logistics	Operations	Operations	9	
4	Showcase Day	PM (Lead)	PM (Lead)	10	
5	Networking session & matchmaking facilitation	PM + Comms	PM + Comms	10	
6	Collect real-time feedback	Coordinator	Coordinator	12	

Phase 5: Post-event & closing

Time: Week 12 to 14

SI no	Activity	Owner	Deliverables	Week	Notes
1	Consolidate feedback & analytics	PM + Data	Event report dashboard	12	

2	Send follow-up to startups & stakeholders	Comms Lead	Follow-up Email sequence	12	
3	Facilitate intro meetings/pilot conversation	PM + Coordinator	Partnership pipeline log	12	
4	Lessons learned session (internal)	PM + Team	Lessons learned register	14	
5	Final Program Report to leadership	PM + Director	Final report Impact scorecard	13	

Roles & responsibilities

Activity / Workstream	Prog. Mgr.	Coordinator	Comms Lead	Tech Lead	Advisor / Director
Program Charter & Governance	A	C	I	I	R
Startup Outreach & Applications	R	A	C	C	I
Screening & Cohort Selection	A	R	I	I	C
Stakeholder Engagement	C	I	R	I	A
Event Logistics & Platform	A	R	C	R	I
Pitch Coaching & Rehearsals	R	A	I	I	C
Showcase Day Execution	R	R	A	C	C
Post-Event Follow-Up	A	R	R	I	I
Reporting & Impact Assessment	R	C	I	C	A

Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Low-quality startup applications	Medium	High	Multi-channel outreach via ecosystem partners (USAID, UNEP, accelerators); minimum 80 leads target
Key stakeholder withdraws late	Low	High	Identify 2 backup VIPs per sector; briefing pack 3 weeks in advance; dedicated relationship owner
Tech failure on showcase day	Medium	High	Full AV/platform rehearsal 48hrs prior; backup streaming link; on-site tech lead
Startup drops out pre-event	Medium	Medium	Maintain waitlist of 3 reserve startups through to Week 10
Insufficient post-event follow-through	Medium	High	Structured 30/60/90-day follow-up cadence; dedicated partnership pipeline log
Scope creep/timeline overrun	Medium	Medium	Weekly PM check-ins; change control log; clear phase gate exit criteria

Success metrics & KPI

Outreach & Pipeline	Cohort Quality	Event Impact	Post-Event Outcomes
80+ qualified applications	8–12 startups selected	NPS > 40 from attendees	5+ intro meetings facilitated
40+ ecosystem orgs engaged	100% pitch-ready by Day -3	90%+ session attendance	2+ LOI / pilot conversations
25+ confirmed stakeholders	Avg. panel score > 3.8/5	Media coverage (2+ articles)	Final report within 2 weeks

Annexures

Annexure A

Startup intake form

1. Company Basics
 - a. Company Name
 - b. Stage
 - c. Founded in
 - d. Team Size
 - e. Current Revenue/ ARR
 - f. Funding raised to date
2. Startup Profile
 - a. Describe the solution (short)
 - b. Which industrial sector does the solution directly apply to?

Sector	Score (1-3)
Steel and metals	
Construction & cement	
Chemical & petrochemical	
Shipping & maritime	
Aviation	
Oil & Gas	
Heavy Manufacturing (other)	

- c. Where in the value chain do you sit?
 - I. Energy efficiency
 - li. Fuel Switching
 - lii. Process innovation
 - Iv. Carbon Capture
 - V. MRV, dMRV
 - Vi. Supply chain decarbonisation
 - Vii. Finance & Carbon markets
- d. What is your TRL?

- I. TRL 1-3
- li. TRL 4-6
- lii. TRL 7-8
- lv. TRL 7-8
- V. TRL 9

3. Primary outcome from the showcase

- a. What is your (the startups) primary goal for this event
 - I. Visibility & awareness
 - li. Pilot project conversation
 - lii. Work order or commercial contract
 - lv. Letter of intent (Loi)
 - V. Strategic partnership
 - Vi. investment / co-investment
 - Vii. other (specify intent)
- b. What kind of conversation are you ready to have at this event?
 - I. Technical Validation (solutions workability)
 - li. Commercial discussion (pricing, procurement, work orders)
 - lii. Strategic Alignment (partnership structure, co-development)
 - lv. Investment conversation (fundraising, strategic capital)
- c. Is there any sector or leader profile that isn't relevant to you?

4. As a mature company, what is the single most valuable outcome from the event?

- a. Supply chain
- b. Strategic partnership or co-development
- c. M&A
- d. Licensing discussion
- e.

Annexure B

Before week 1

- 1. Your organisation
 - a. Organisation name
 - b. Your role
 - c. Primary industrial sector
 - d. Annual decarbonisation budget
 - i. <\$1M ii. \$1-10M iii. \$10-50M iv. >\$50M

- e. Do you have active procurement open this year?
i. yes ii. No iii. In planning

2. What are your top 3 decarbonisation challenges right now?

Challenge	Rank
	1
	2
	3

3. Which parts of the decarbonisation value chain are you actively seeking solutions for?

Area	Your score (1-3)
Energy Efficiency	
Fuel Switching	
Process Innovation	
Carbon Capture	
MRV, dMRV, carbon accounting	
Supply chain decarbonisation	
Carbon markets/ offsets	

4. What stage of startup are you most willing to engage with?

- a. Early stage (pilots, R&D partnerships)
- b. Growth stage (Work orders, procurement trials)
- c. Mature (strategic contracts, investments)
- d. All stages

5. What does a successful meeting look like for you?

6. Rate your current awareness of available decarbonisation solutions in your sector: ____ (1-10)

7. Rate your organisation's readiness to engage a new supplier / partner today: ____ (1-10)

Annexure C

Calculation after the forms are returned:

Relevance Score = (Startup sector score x Leader urgency score) + (Value chain alignment bonus: +2 if both score ≥ 2 on the same area) + (Stage match bonus: +1 if leader is willing to engage that stage)

// calculations took time -hence deprioritised

Max possible score = $(3 \times 3) + 2 + 1 = 12$ // perfect match - Cap

8 meetings per leader

30 startups

Thus, we're selecting **27%** pairings per leader

From this, a higher score would imply a stronger match; scores above 8 get scheduled, and scores below 5 get filtered out. Because it represents less than 40% of the maximum fit

Annexure D

Referenced to an earlier project built for TIE Bangalore Global Startup Awards